

BibInVs MN 54

Timothy1

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 54*

God

Table of Contents

- 1 Timothy 1
- 1 Timothy 2
- 1 Timothy 3
- 1 Timothy 4
- 1 Timothy 5
- 1 Timothy 6

Interversed Message/NIV Bible

1 Timothy

1 Timothy 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 I, Paul, am an apostle on special assignment for Christ, our living hope. Under God our Savior's command,
- 1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the command of God our Savior and of Christ Jesus our hope,
- 2 I'm writing this to you, Timothy, my son in the faith. All the best from our God and Christ be yours!
- 2 To Timothy my true son in the faith: Grace, mercy and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.
- 3 On my way to the province of Macedonia, I advised you to stay in Ephesus. Well, I haven't changed my mind. Stay right there on top of things so that the teaching stays on track.
- 3 As I urged you when I went into Macedonia, stay there in Ephesus so that you may command certain men not to teach false doctrines any longer
- 4 Apparently some people have been introducing fantasy stories and fanciful family trees that digress into silliness instead of pulling the people back into the center, deepening faith and obedience.
- 4 nor to devote themselves to myths and endless genealogies. These promote controversies rather than God's work--which is by faith.
- 5 The whole point of what we're urging is simply love--love uncontaminated by self-interest and counterfeit faith, a life open to God.
- 5 The goal of this command is love, which comes from a pure heart and a good conscience and a sincere faith.
- 6 Those who fail to keep to this point soon wander off into cul-de-sacs of gossip.
- 6 Some have wandered away from these and turned to meaningless talk.
- 7 They set themselves up as experts on religious issues, but haven't the remotest idea of what they're holding forth with such imposing

eloquence.

- 7 They want to be teachers of the law, but they do not know what they are talking about or what they so confidently affirm.
- 8 It's true that moral guidance and counsel need to be given, but the way you say it and to whom you say it are as important as what you say.
- 8 We know that the law is good if one uses it properly.
- 9 It's obvious, isn't it, that the law code isn't primarily for people who live responsibly, but for the irresponsible, who defy all authority, riding roughshod over God, life,
- 9 We also know that law is made not for the righteous but for lawbreakers and rebels, the ungodly and sinful, the unholy and irreligious; for those who kill their fathers or mothers, for murderers,
- 10 sex, truth, whatever!
- 10 for adulterers and perverts, for slave traders and liars and perjurers-- and for whatever else is contrary to the sound doctrine
- 11 They are contemptuous of this great Message I've been put in charge of by this great God.
- 11 that conforms to the glorious gospel of the blessed God, which he entrusted to me.
- 12 I'm so grateful to Christ Jesus for making me adequate to do this work. He went out on a limb, you know, in trusting me with this ministry.
- 12 I thank Christ Jesus our Lord, who has given me strength, that he considered me faithful, appointing me to his service.
- 13 The only credentials I brought to it were invective and witch hunts and arrogance. But I was treated mercifully because I didn't know what I was doing--didn't know Who I was doing it against!
- 13 Even though I was once a blasphemer and a persecutor and a violent man, I was shown mercy because I acted in ignorance and unbelief.
- 14 Grace mixed with faith and love poured over me and into me. And all because of Jesus.
- 14 The grace of our Lord was poured out on me abundantly, along with the faith and love that are in Christ Jesus.
- 15 Here's a word you can take to heart and depend on: Jesus Christ came into the world to save sinners. I'm proof--Public Sinner Number One--
- 15 Here is a trustworthy saying that deserves full acceptance: Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners--of whom I am the worst.

- 16 of someone who could never have made it apart from sheer mercy. And now he shows me off--evidence of his endless patience--to those who are right on the edge of trusting him forever.
- 16 But for that very reason I was shown mercy so that in me, the worst of sinners, Christ Jesus might display his unlimited patience as an example for those who would believe on him and receive eternal life.
- 17 Deep honor and bright glory to the King of All Time-- One God, Immortal, Invisible, ever and always. Oh, yes!
- 17 Now to the King eternal, immortal, invisible, the only God, be honor and glory for ever and ever. Amen.
- 18 I'm passing this work on to you, my son Timothy. The prophetic word that was directed to you prepared us for this. All those prayers are coming together now so you will do this well, fearless in your struggle,
- 18 Timothy, my son, I give you this instruction in keeping with the prophecies once made about you, so that by following them you may fight the good fight,
- 19 keeping a firm grip on your faith and on yourself. After all, this is a fight we're in. There are some, you know, who by relaxing their grip and thinking anything goes have made a thorough mess of their faith.
- 19 holding on to faith and a good conscience. Some have rejected these and so have shipwrecked their faith.
- 20 Hymenaeus and Alexander are two of them. I let them wander off to Satan to be taught a lesson or two about not blaspheming.
- 20 Among them are Hymenaeus and Alexander, whom I have handed over to Satan to be taught not to blaspheme.

1 Timothy 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 The first thing I want you to do is pray. Pray every way you know how, for everyone you know.
- 1 I urge, then, first of all, that requests, prayers, intercession and thanksgiving be made for everyone--
- 2 Pray especially for rulers and their governments to rule well so we can be quietly about our business of living simply, in humble contemplation.

2 for kings and all those in authority, that we may live peaceful and quiet lives in all godliness and holiness.

3 This is the way our Savior God wants us to live.

3 This is good, and pleases God our Savior,

4 He wants not only us but everyone saved, you know, everyone to get to know the truth we've learned:

4 who wants all men to be saved and to come to a knowledge of the truth.

5 that there's one God and only one, and one Priest-Mediator between God and us--Jesus,

5 For there is one God and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus,

6 who offered himself in exchange for everyone held captive by sin, to set them all free. Eventually the news is going to get out.

6 who gave himself as a ransom for all men--the testimony given in its proper time.

7 This and this only has been my appointed work: getting this news to those who have never heard of God, and explaining how it works by simple faith and plain truth.

7 And for this purpose I was appointed a herald and an apostle--I am telling the truth, I am not lying--and a teacher of the true faith to the Gentiles.

8 Since prayer is at the bottom of all this, what I want mostly is for men to pray--not shaking angry fists at enemies but raising holy hands to God.

8 I want men everywhere to lift up holy hands in prayer, without anger or disputing.

9 And I want women to get in there with the men in humility before God, not primping before a mirror or chasing the latest fashions

9 I also want women to dress modestly, with decency and propriety, not with braided hair or gold or pearls or expensive clothes,

10 but doing something beautiful for God and becoming beautiful doing it.

10 but with good deeds, appropriate for women who profess to worship God.

11 I don't let women take over and tell the men what to do.

11 A woman should learn in quietness and full submission.

12 They should study to be quiet and obedient along with everyone else.

12 I do not permit a woman to teach or to have authority over a man; she must be silent.

- 13 Adam was made first, then Eve;
13 For Adam was formed first, then Eve.
14 woman was deceived first--our pioneer in sin!--with Adam right on her heels.
14 And Adam was not the one deceived; it was the woman who was deceived and became a sinner.
15 On the other hand, her childbearing brought about salvation, reversing Eve. But this salvation only comes to those who continue in faith, love, and holiness, gathering it all into maturity. You can depend on this.
15 But women will be saved through childbearing--if they continue in faith, love and holiness with propriety.

1 Timothy 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 If anyone wants to provide leadership in the church, good!
1 Here is a trustworthy saying: If anyone sets his heart on being an overseer, he desires a noble task.
2 But there are preconditions: A leader must be well-thought-of, committed to his wife, cool and collected, accessible, and hospitable. He must know what he's talking about,
2 Now the overseer must be above reproach, the husband of but one wife, temperate, self- controlled, respectable, hospitable, able to teach,
3 not be overfond of wine, not pushy but gentle, not thin-skinned, not money-hungry.
3 not given to drunkenness, not violent but gentle, not quarrelsome, not a lover of money.
4 He must handle his own affairs well, attentive to his own children and having their respect.
4 He must manage his own family well and see that his children obey him with proper respect.
5 For if someone is unable to handle his own affairs, how can he take care of God's church?
5 (If anyone does not know how to manage his own family, how can he take care of God's church?)

- 6 He must not be a new believer, lest the position go to his head and the Devil trip him up.
- 6 He must not be a recent convert, or he may become conceited and fall under the same judgment as the devil.
- 7 Outsiders must think well of him, or else the Devil will figure out a way to lure him into his trap.
- 7 He must also have a good reputation with outsiders, so that he will not fall into disgrace and into the devil's trap.
- 8 The same goes for those who want to be servants in the church: serious, not deceitful, not too free with the bottle, not in it for what they can get out of it.
- 8 Deacons, likewise, are to be men worthy of respect, sincere, not indulging in much wine, and not pursuing dishonest gain.
- 9 They must be reverent before the mystery of the faith, not using their position to try to run things.
- 9 They must keep hold of the deep truths of the faith with a clear conscience.
- 10 Let them prove themselves first. If they show they can do it, take them on.
- 10 They must first be tested; and then if there is nothing against them, let them serve as deacons.
- 11 No exceptions are to be made for women--same qualifications: serious, dependable, not sharp-tongued, not overfond of wine.
- 11 In the same way, their wives are to be women worthy of respect, not malicious talkers but temperate and trustworthy in everything.
- 12 Servants in the church are to be committed to their spouses, attentive to their own children, and diligent in looking after their own affairs.
- 12 A deacon must be the husband of but one wife and must manage his children and his household well.
- 13 Those who do this servant work will come to be highly respected, a real credit to this Jesus-faith.
- 13 Those who have served well gain an excellent standing and great assurance in their faith in Christ Jesus.
- 14 I hope to visit you soon, but just in case I'm delayed, I'm writing this letter so

- 14 Although I hope to come to you soon, I am writing you these instructions so that,
- 15 you'll know how things ought to go in God's household, this God-alive church, bastion of truth.
- 15 if I am delayed, you will know how people ought to conduct themselves in God's household, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and foundation of the truth.
- 16 This Christian life is a great mystery, far exceeding our understanding, but some things are clear enough: He appeared in a human body, was proved right by the invisible Spirit, was seen by angels. He was proclaimed among all kinds of peoples, believed in all over the world, taken up into heavenly glory.
- 16 Beyond all question, the mystery of godliness is great: He appeared in a body, was vindicated by the Spirit, was seen by angels, was preached among the nations, was believed on in the world, was taken up in glory.

1 Timothy 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Spirit makes it clear that as time goes on, some are going to give up on the faith and chase after demonic illusions put forth by professional liars.
- 1 The Spirit clearly says that in later times some will abandon the faith and follow deceiving spirits and things taught by demons.
- 2 These liars have lied so well and for so long that they've lost their capacity for truth.
- 2 Such teachings come through hypocritical liars, whose consciences have been seared as with a hot iron.
- 3 They will tell you not to get married. They'll tell you not to eat this or that food--perfectly good food God created to be eaten heartily and with thanksgiving by Christians!
- 3 They forbid people to marry and order them to abstain from certain foods, which God created to be received with thanksgiving by those who believe and who know the truth.

- 4 Everything God created is good, and to be received with thanks. Nothing is to be sneered at and thrown out.
- 4 For everything God created is good, and nothing is to be rejected if it is received with thanksgiving,
- 5 God's Word and our prayers make every item in creation holy.
- 5 because it is consecrated by the word of God and prayer.
- 6 You've been raised on the Message of the faith and have followed sound teaching. Now pass on this counsel to the Christians there, and you'll be a good servant of Jesus.
- 6 If you point these things out to the brothers, you will be a good minister of Christ Jesus, brought up in the truths of the faith and of the good teaching that you have followed.
- 7 Stay clear of silly stories that get dressed up as religion. Exercise daily in God--no spiritual flabbiness, please!
- 7 Have nothing to do with godless myths and old wives' tales; rather, train yourself to be godly.
- 8 Workouts in the gymnasium are useful, but a disciplined life in God is far more so, making you fit both today and forever.
- 8 For physical training is of some value, but godliness has value for all things, holding promise for both the present life and the life to come.
- 9 You can count on this. Take it to heart.
- 9 This is a trustworthy saying that deserves full acceptance
- 10 This is why we've thrown ourselves into this venture so totally. We're banking on the living God, Savior of all men and women, especially believers.
- 10 (and for this we labor and strive), that we have put our hope in the living God, who is the Savior of all men, and especially of those who believe.
- 11 Get the word out. Teach all these things.
- 11 Command and teach these things.
- 12 And don't let anyone put you down because you're young. Teach believers with your life: by word, by demeanor, by love, by faith, by integrity.
- 12 Don't let anyone look down on you because you are young, but set an example for the believers in speech, in life, in love, in faith and in purity.
- 13 Stay at your post reading Scripture, giving counsel, teaching.

- 13 Until I come, devote yourself to the public reading of Scripture, to preaching and to teaching.
- 14 And that special gift of ministry you were given when the leaders of the church laid hands on you and prayed--keep that dusted off and in use.
- 14 Do not neglect your gift, which was given you through a prophetic message when the body of elders laid their hands on you.
- 15 Cultivate these things. Immerse yourself in them. The people will all see you mature right before their eyes!
- 15 Be diligent in these matters; give yourself wholly to them, so that everyone may see your progress.
- 16 Keep a firm grasp on both your character and your teaching. Don't be diverted. Just keep at it. Both you and those who hear you will experience salvation.
- 16 Watch your life and doctrine closely. Persevere in them, because if you do, you will save both yourself and your hearers.

1 Timothy 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Don't be harsh or impatient with an older man. Talk to him as you would your own father, and to the younger men as your brothers.
- 1 Do not rebuke an older man harshly, but exhort him as if he were your father. Treat younger men as brothers,
- 2 Reverently honor an older woman as you would your mother, and the younger women as sisters.
- 2 older women as mothers, and younger women as sisters, with absolute purity.
- 3 Take care of widows who are destitute.
- 3 Give proper recognition to those widows who are really in need.
- 4 If a widow has family members to take care of her, let them learn that religion begins at their own doorstep and that they should pay back with gratitude some of what they have received. This pleases God immensely.
- 4 But if a widow has children or grandchildren, these should learn first of all to put their religion into practice by caring for their own family and so repaying their parents and grandparents, for this is pleasing to God.

- 5 You can tell a legitimate widow by the way she has put all her hope in God, praying to him constantly for the needs of others as well as her own.
- 5 The widow who is really in need and left all alone puts her hope in God and continues night and day to pray and to ask God for help.
- 6 But a widow who exploits people's emotions and pocketbooks--well, there's nothing to her.
- 6 But the widow who lives for pleasure is dead even while she lives.
- 7 Tell these things to the people so that they will do the right thing in their extended family.
- 7 Give the people these instructions, too, so that no one may be open to blame.
- 8 Anyone who neglects to care for family members in need repudiates the faith. That's worse than refusing to believe in the first place.
- 8 If anyone does not provide for his relatives, and especially for his immediate family, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever.
- 9 Sign some widows up for the special ministry of offering assistance. They will in turn receive support from the church. They must be over sixty, married only once,
- 9 No widow may be put on the list of widows unless she is over sixty, has been faithful to her husband,
- 10 and have a reputation for helping out with children, strangers, tired Christians, the hurt and troubled.
- 10 and is well known for her good deeds, such as bringing up children, showing hospitality, washing the feet of the saints, helping those in trouble and devoting herself to all kinds of good deeds.
- 11 Don't put young widows on this list. No sooner will they get on than they'll want to get off, obsessed with wanting to get a husband rather than serving Christ in this way.
- 11 As for younger widows, do not put them on such a list. For when their sensual desires overcome their dedication to Christ, they want to marry.
- 12 By breaking their word, they're liable to go from bad to worse,
- 12 Thus they bring judgment on themselves, because they have broken their first pledge.
- 13 frittering away their days on empty talk, gossip, and trivialities.

- 13 Besides, they get into the habit of being idle and going about from house to house. And not only do they become idlers, but also gossips and busybodies, saying things they ought not to.
- 14 No, I'd rather the young widows go ahead and get married in the first place, have children, manage their homes, and not give critics any foothold for finding fault.
- 14 So I counsel younger widows to marry, to have children, to manage their homes and to give the enemy no opportunity for slander.
- 15 Some of them have already left and gone after Satan.
- 15 Some have in fact already turned away to follow Satan.
- 16 Any Christian woman who has widows in her family is responsible for them. They shouldn't be dumped on the church. The church has its hands full already with widows who need help.
- 16 If any woman who is a believer has widows in her family, she should help them and not let the church be burdened with them, so that the church can help those widows who are really in need.
- 17 Give a bonus to leaders who do a good job, especially the ones who work hard at preaching and teaching.
- 17 The elders who direct the affairs of the church well are worthy of double honor, especially those whose work is preaching and teaching.
- 18 Scripture tells us, "Don't muzzle a working ox," and, "A worker deserves his pay."
- 18 For the Scripture says, "Do not muzzle the ox while it is treading out the grain," and "The worker deserves his wages."
- 19 Don't listen to a complaint against a leader that isn't backed up by two or three responsible witnesses.
- 19 Do not entertain an accusation against an elder unless it is brought by two or three witnesses.
- 20 If anyone falls into sin, call that person on the carpet. Those who are inclined that way will know right off they can't get by with it.
- 20 Those who sin are to be rebuked publicly, so that the others may take warning.
- 21 God and Jesus and angels all back me up in these instructions. Carry them out without favoritism, without taking sides.
- 21 I charge you, in the sight of God and Christ Jesus and the elect angels, to keep these instructions without partiality, and to do nothing out of

favoritism.

- 22 Don't appoint people to church leadership positions too hastily. If a person is involved in some serious sins, you don't want to become an unwitting accomplice. In any event, keep a close check on yourself.
- 22 Do not be hasty in the laying on of hands, and do not share in the sins of others. Keep yourself pure.
- 23 And don't worry too much about what the critics will say. Go ahead and drink a little wine, for instance; it's good for your digestion, good medicine for what ails you.
- 23 Stop drinking only water, and use a little wine because of your stomach and your frequent illnesses.
- 24 The sins of some people are blatant and march them right into court. The sins of others don't show up until much later.
- 24 The sins of some men are obvious, reaching the place of judgment ahead of them; the sins of others trail behind them.
- 25 The same with good deeds. Some you see right off, but none are hidden forever.
- 25 In the same way, good deeds are obvious, and even those that are not cannot be hidden.

1 Timothy 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Whoever is a slave must make the best of it, giving respect to his master so that outsiders don't blame God and our teaching for his behavior.
- 1 All who are under the yoke of slavery should consider their masters worthy of full respect, so that God's name and our teaching may not be slandered.
- 2 Slaves with Christian masters all the more so--their masters are really their beloved brothers! These are the things I want you to teach and preach.
- 2 Those who have believing masters are not to show less respect for them because they are brothers. Instead, they are to serve them even better, because those who benefit from their service are believers, and dear to them. These are the things you are to teach and urge on them.

- 3 If you have leaders there who teach otherwise, who refuse the solid words of our Master Jesus and this godly instruction,
- 3 If anyone teaches false doctrines and does not agree to the sound instruction of our Lord Jesus Christ and to godly teaching,
- 4 tag them for what they are: ignorant windbags who infect the air with germs of envy, controversy, bad-mouthing, suspicious rumors.
- 4 he is conceited and understands nothing. He has an unhealthy interest in controversies and quarrels about words that result in envy, strife, malicious talk, evil suspicions
- 5 Eventually there's an epidemic of backstabbing, and truth is but a distant memory. They think religion is a way to make a fast buck.
- 5 and constant friction between men of corrupt mind, who have been robbed of the truth and who think that godliness is a means to financial gain.
- 6 A devout life does bring wealth, but it's the rich simplicity of being yourself before God.
- 6 But godliness with contentment is great gain.
- 7 Since we entered the world penniless and will leave it penniless,
- 7 For we brought nothing into the world, and we can take nothing out of it.
- 8 if we have bread on the table and shoes on our feet, that's enough.
- 8 But if we have food and clothing, we will be content with that.
- 9 But if it's only money these leaders are after, they'll self-destruct in no time.
- 9 People who want to get rich fall into temptation and a trap and into many foolish and harmful desires that plunge men into ruin and destruction.
- 10 Lust for money brings trouble and nothing but trouble. Going down that path, some lose their footing in the faith completely and live to regret it bitterly ever after.
- 10 For the love of money is a root of all kinds of evil. Some people, eager for money, have wandered from the faith and pierced themselves with many griefs.
- 11 But you, Timothy, man of God: Run for your life from all this. Pursue a righteous life--a life of wonder, faith, love, steadiness, courtesy.
- 11 But you, man of God, flee from all this, and pursue righteousness, godliness, faith, love, endurance and gentleness.

- 12 Run hard and fast in the faith. Seize the eternal life, the life you were called to, the life you so fervently embraced in the presence of so many witnesses.
- 12 Fight the good fight of the faith. Take hold of the eternal life to which you were called when you made your good confession in the presence of many witnesses.
- 13 I'm charging you before the life-giving God and before Christ, who took his stand before Pontius Pilate and didn't give an inch:
- 13 In the sight of God, who gives life to everything, and of Christ Jesus, who while testifying before Pontius Pilate made the good confession, I charge you
- 14 Keep this command to the letter, and don't slack off. Our Master, Jesus Christ, is on his way.
- 14 to keep this command without spot or blame until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ,
- 15 He'll show up right on time, his arrival guaranteed by the Blessed and Undisputed Ruler, High King, High God.
- 15 which God will bring about in his own time--God, the blessed and only Ruler, the King of kings and Lord of lords,
- 16 He's the only one death can't touch, his light so bright no one can get close. He's never been seen by human eyes--human eyes can't take him in! Honor to him, and eternal rule! Oh, yes.
- 16 who alone is immortal and who lives in unapproachable light, whom no one has seen or can see. To him be honor and might forever. Amen.
- 17 Tell those rich in this world's wealth to quit being so full of themselves and so obsessed with money, which is here today and gone tomorrow. Tell them to go after God, who piles on all the riches we could ever manage--
- 17 Command those who are rich in this present world not to be arrogant nor to put their hope in wealth, which is so uncertain, but to put their hope in God, who richly provides us with everything for our enjoyment.
- 18 to do good, to be rich in helping others, to be extravagantly generous.
- 18 Command them to do good, to be rich in good deeds, and to be generous and willing to share.
- 19 If they do that, they'll build a treasury that will last, gaining life that is truly life.

- 19 In this way they will lay up treasure for themselves as a firm foundation for the coming age, so that they may take hold of the life that is truly life.
- 20 And oh, my dear Timothy, guard the treasure you were given! Guard it with your life. Avoid the talk-show religion and the practiced confusion of the so-called experts.
- 20 Timothy, guard what has been entrusted to your care. Turn away from godless chatter and the opposing ideas of what is falsely called knowledge,
- 21 People caught up in a lot of talk can miss the whole point of faith. Overwhelming grace keep you!
- 21 which some have professed and in so doing have wandered from the faith. Grace be with you.